STERLING & DRAPER · VIDEO AD ANALYSIS

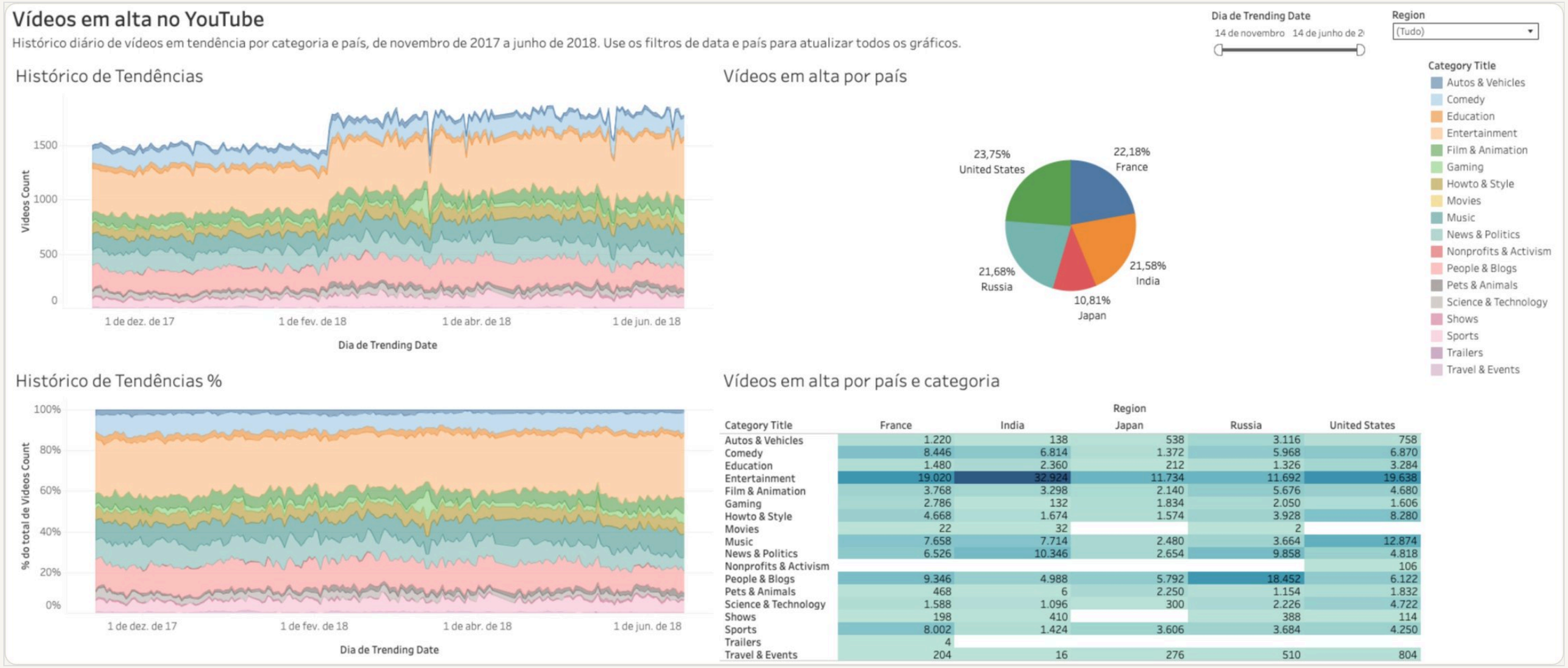
Trending Videos on YouTube

What trended between November 2017 and June 2018, by category and by country

Luciana Jost · October 2026

The dashboard

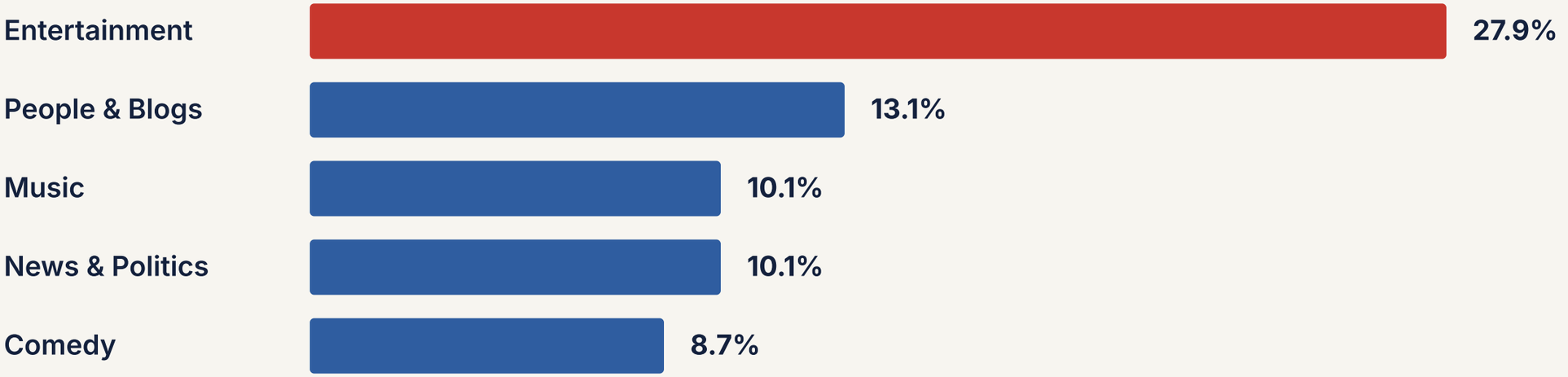
Four views and two filters (date and country) that update everything together · open in Tableau Public



Category Title	Region				
	France	India	Japan	Russia	United States
Autos & Vehicles	1.220	138	538	3.116	758
Comedy	8.446	6.814	1.372	5.968	6.870
Education	1.480	2.360	212	1.326	3.284
Entertainment	19.020	32.924	11.734	11.692	19.638
Film & Animation	3.768	3.298	2.140	5.676	4.680
Gaming	2.786	132	1.834	2.050	1.606
Howto & Style	4.668	1.674	1.574	3.928	8.280
Movies	22	32		2	
Music	7.658	7.714	2.480	3.664	12.874
News & Politics	6.526	10.346	2.654	9.858	4.818
Nonprofits & Activism					106
People & Blogs	9.346	4.988	5.792	18.452	6.122
Pets & Animals	468	6	2.250	1.154	1.832
Science & Technology	1.588	1.096	300	2.226	4.722
Shows	198	410		388	114
Sports	8.002	1.424	3.606	3.684	4.250
Trailers	4				
Travel & Events	204	16	276	510	804

QUESTION 1

Entertainment dominates: more than double the runner-up



The top five categories account for about 70% of all trending videos.

% of all trending videos, all regions, 14 Nov 2017 to 14 Jun 2018 (339,990 records)

QUESTION 2

Four countries neck and neck; Japan arrived later

23.8%	22.2%	21.7%	21.6%	10.8%
US	France	Russia	India	Japan

Japan only enters the data on **07 Feb 2018** (122 days, versus 205 for the others). That entry is what makes the daily total jump from ~1,450 to ~1,790 videos, not a real increase in trends. Each country keeps a stable daily volume (US: 378 to 400 videos per day).

% of all trending videos by region, 14 Nov 2017 to 14 Jun 2018

QUESTION 3

In the US, music and how-to videos weigh twice as much

Category	US	Other countries
Music	15.9% (more)	8.3%
Howto & Style	10.3% (more)	4.6%
Science & Technology	5.8% (more)	2.0%
Education	4.1% (more)	2.1%
People & Blogs	7.6% (less)	14.9%
News & Politics	6.0% (less)	11.3%

Top 3 in the US

1. Entertainment 24.3%
2. Music 15.9%
3. Howto & Style 10.3%

Outside the US, the top 3 are Entertainment, People & Blogs and News & Politics.

% of each group's trending videos by category. Other countries: France, India, Japan and Russia combined

Takeaways for ad planning

Everywhere

Entertainment is the safest bet: it leads in four of the five countries and accounts for 27.9% of everything.

In the US

Prioritize Music, Howto & Style and Science & Technology, which carry two to three times the weight they have in other markets.

Outside the US

People & Blogs and News & Politics carry twice the weight. In Russia, People & Blogs is the top category.

When comparing periods, remember that Japan only enters from February 2018: use the country filter so a new market entering the data is not mistaken for growth.

Dashboard: public.tableau.com/views/YouTubeTrendingDashboard_17908531142200/Painel1